ONE-PAGE PREACHING OUTLINE

The Woman Who Ended the War

Jael · Judges 4:1–24

Primary text: Judges 4:1–24 **Also read:** Judges 5 · Luke 1:26–45 · Colossians 2:13–15 · 1 Corinthians 1:26–31 **Big idea:** Jael drove a tent peg through the enemy's head and was called blessed; Jesus let the nails be driven into his hands and made peace for his enemies. **Time:** 55–60 minutes, including a 3–5 minute response (6,955 words at about 120 wpm). **Aim:** From hiding to trusting the God who wins through the unlikely; from vengeance to the cross.

MOVEMENT MAP

MIN	SECTION	BEATS AND TRANSITION
5	**Introduction: The story we skip**	The story we sanitize: Deborah and the chariots make the flannelgraph; the tent peg does not. Yet Deborah's song calls Jael "most blessed of women." → *"Let us read the story."*
7	**The twenty-year silence**	Israel does evil; the LORD sells them to Jabin; 900 iron chariots; twenty years. They cry out. Deborah judges under the palm. Barak's commission: 10,000 at Tabor; God draws Sisera to Kishon. Barak: "If you will go with me…" Deborah: the honor will go to a woman. → *"Which woman?"*
8	**The battle at Kishon**	Deborah's battle cry: "Does not the LORD go out before you?" The LORD routs Sisera; not a man is left. The stars fight; the torrent sweeps them away. Sisera abandons his chariot and runs to Jael's tent; Heber has peace with Jabin. → *"He runs to the wrong door."*
8	**The open door**	Jael goes out to meet him: "Turn aside, my lord; do not be afraid." The rug, the milk, the lordly bowl of curds. He asks her to guard the door and lie. Hospitality, treaty, and the sleeping general. The moral tension: she will betray a guest. The text does not explain her motives. → *"She takes what is in her hand."*
8	**The peg and the hammer**	"She went softly to him and drove the peg into his temple." The song: "She crushed his head." Genesis 3:15 echo. Barak arrives; Jael shows him the dead general. The war ends; Jabin is destroyed. Meroz is cursed for staying home; Jael is blessed for risking everything. → *"A foreign woman with a tent peg."*
8	**Blessed among women**	Judges 5:24. Luke 1:42: the echo over Mary. Jael kills the enemy; Mary bears the Son who takes the nails. We are Sisera, not Israel. Colossians 2:13–15: the record of debt nailed to the cross; the powers disarmed. The resurrection ends the war. → *"He took the nails that were meant for us."*
6	**Application: What do you do with the tent peg?**	Do not wait for the perfect moment. Do not mistake peace for passivity. Use what is in your hand. Give the victory to God. → *"Do your part; leave the outcome to Him."*
3	**The invitation**	Sisera: running. Barak: afraid. Jael: overlooked. Come to the One who took the nail. → *"The door is open."*
4	**Response and closing**	Silence. Which person are you? Colossians 2:13–15. Prayer. Care note for victims of violence. The tent peg ended a war; the nails ended the enmity. → *"Go in peace, and live like people whose war is over."*

Total: 57 minutes; 55–60 with normal variation.

LINES TO LAND

- "The LORD routed Sisera and all his chariots and all his army."
- "Most blessed of women be Jael, the wife of Heber the Kenite."
- "Jael drove a peg into the enemy; Jesus took the nails for his enemies."
- "The tent peg ended a war. The nails ended the enmity."

GUARDRAILS

- Do not glamorize the killing. Name the deception and the broken treaty. Jael is God's instrument in this war, not a model for private revenge.
- Do not make Jael or Deborah a culture-war mascot. The point is God's deliverance through the unlikely, not a template for every conflict.
- Preach the violence with care. The sermon is not a command to take vengeance (Romans 12:19); provide a care note for victims of abuse.
- Keep the typology modest. Genesis 3:15 is an echo, not a direct prophecy; the tent peg is not a prophecy of the nails. "Blessed among women" is resonance, not fulfillment.
- Do not despise Barak. Hebrews 11:32 names him among the faithful; his is a weak faith that still obeys.
- The gospel must be explicit: Colossians 2:13–15 and the resurrection. Do not end on "be brave."

IF YOU MUST CUT

- **To 50 minutes:** Introduction 4, Movement 1 6, Movement 2 6, Movement 3 7, Movement 4 7, Movement 5 7, Application 5. Keep 4:9, "the LORD routed," the peg, Judges 5:24, and Colossians 2:13–15.
- **Never cut:** "The LORD routed Sisera," "Most blessed of women be Jael," the tent peg, the Mary echo, the cross and resurrection.